Jamiatu Muslim Mindanao

Jamiatu Muslim Mindanao (JMM), also known as the **University of Muslim Mindanao**, stands as one of the oldest and most established madaris in the Philippines. It operates as a private, sectarian institution focused on Islamic education alongside basic and higher learning programs. Founded in **1956**, it has served generations of Muslim Filipinos, particularly in Mindanao, by blending traditional Arabic-Islamic studies with elements of the national curriculum.

The school is located in Darussalam, Matampay, Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, along the Amai Pakpak national highway. Its main campus covers about 3 hectares (roughly 29,995 square meters). It features concrete buildings, a mosque, dormitories, a social hall, and sports facilities for soccer, basketball, and volleyball. The medium of instruction includes Filipino, English, and Arabic, with school colors of pink, white, and black. Students and affiliates sometimes refer to it by the nickname "Matampay."

Contents

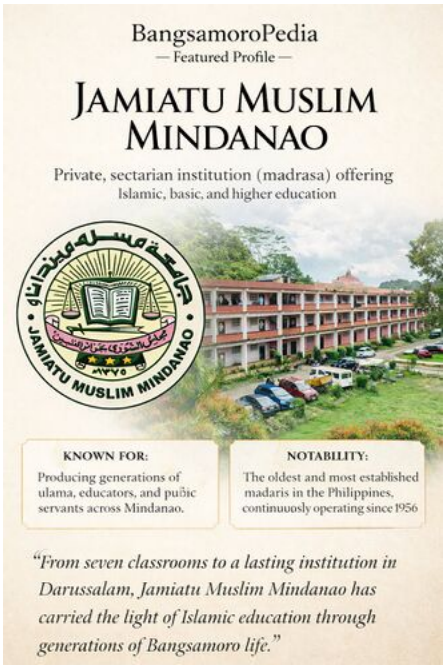
1 History and Founding
2 Vision, Mission, and Core Values
3 Institutional Development and Academic Structure
4 Administration and Leadership
5 Student Life, Traditions, and Milestones
6 Contributions and Impact
7 Research Assessment

History and Founding

JMM traces its roots to the Agama Islam Society, established in 1956 by **Sheikh Ahmad Bashir** (also spelled Basher or Bashir, 1919–1989) and his companions from ulama (Ustad) and traditional (Cali) groups. Sheikh Bashir served as founding president and chairman. They began with a simple madrasa called **Madrasatul Arabiya** in seven classrooms at the residence of former Lanao del Sur Provincial Governor **Abdulgaffor Madki Alonto** in Lolong, Dansalan (the old name for Marawi). The first cohort included about 150 students and eight teachers.

Key early milestones include a 1961 land agreement with **Sheikh Abdurrahman Pacasum** for use in Lumbaca Madaya (30 years, no rent), the establishment of **Ma'had Mindanao Al-Arabie Al-Islamie** as a secondary school that year, and the 1962 founding of **Agama Islam Academy in Ganassi** for English education (which operated

Jamiatu Muslim Mindanao



Also Known As
University of Muslim Mindanao

Type
Private, sectarian institution (madrasa) offering Islamic, basic, and higher education

Founded
1956

Founder
Sheikh Ahmad Bashir

Location
Darussalam, Matampay, Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Campus Size
Approximately 3 hectares (29,995 square meters)

Medium of Instruction
Filipino, English, Arabic

School Colors
Pink, White, Black

Nickname
Matampay

Affiliation
League of Islamic Universities (Cairo)

Current Leadership
Mahdi Ahmad Basher, President/CEO

Notability
One of the oldest and most established madaris in the Philippines, continuously

until 1987). In 1972, the main operations moved to the current Darussalam site with assistance from local leaders and a presidential proclamation excluding part of the land from military reservation. Additional land donations supported growth.

In 1987, through Board Resolution No. 1-87, the institution adopted its current name and formalized its English Department. This aligned with Ministry of Education, Culture and Sports (MECS) Order No. 24 (1985) on madrasa recognition. The programs drew inspiration from the **1977 First World Conference on Muslim Education in Jeddah**, aiming to balance spiritual and material needs for Muslim Filipinos in a modern society. Courses follow government-approved curricula enriched with Islamic and Arabic elements.

operating since 1956

Known For

Producing generations of ulama, educators, and public servants across Mindanao, including former ARMM Vice-Governor Mahid Mutilan

Pull Quote

"From seven classrooms in Lolong to a lasting institution in Darussalam, Jamiatu Muslim Mindanao has carried the light of Islamic education through generations of Bangsamoro life."

Vision, Mission, and Core Values

JMM's vision centers on Islamic education as a comprehensive solution emphasizing spiritual, moral, physical, intellectual, social, and technical development to combat ignorance, poverty, illiteracy, and social ills. Its mission focuses on developing peace-loving, service-oriented individuals through spirituality, morality, honesty, and integrity, with a particular eye toward Mindanao's development. Specific objectives include offering Islam-oriented education to various Muslim tribes (Maranao, Maguindanao, Tausug, and others), serving as a center for Arabic and Islamic studies, supporting literacy efforts, providing manpower training, and acting as a repository for Muslim literature and texts.

Institutional Development and Academic Structure

JMM offers a full spectrum of Islamic education: kindergarten, complete elementary, secondary (with K-12 alignment, including senior high strands), and collegiate levels, plus some graduate programs. It has historically maintained branches across the Philippines (reported at 132, mostly in Mindanao), though current active numbers may vary. It provides technical-vocational courses like Computer Hardware Servicing NC II and has received recognitions for degree programs such as Master of Arts in Education, Master in Public Administration, BS Computer Science, and others from ARMM/CHED-ARMM authorities around 2014.

As a madrasa, it prioritizes traditional Sunni Islamic studies and Arabic while integrating secular subjects for broader relevance. It is affiliated with the League of Islamic Universities (Cairo) and was elected to its Executive Council in 1999. It has also connected with ARTVET and MINTVET.

Administration and Leadership

Sheikh Ahmad Bashir led from founding until his death in 1989. His son, **Mahdi Ahmad Basher** (or Basher), has served as president/CEO for many years. Other figures like **Aleem Jalaloden Sarangani** (vice president, who passed away around mid-2024) have held key roles. Governance involves a Board of Trustees, with roots in the original founding board members (a list of ulama and community leaders is documented in historical accounts).

Student Life, Traditions, and Milestones

Student life revolves around Islamic values, with activities including Qur'an recitation, sports, and community engagement. Annual commencement exercises, such as the 35th Joint Commencement and 10th Moving Up Ceremony in 2025 at the Sheikh Ahmad Basher Function Hall, highlight graduations and cultural continuity. The 50th golden jubilee in 2006 featured exhibits, contests, and reflections on its role in Arabic education.

Notable milestones include government recognition in 1987, international affiliations, land developments, and producing graduates who enter public service, education, and community leadership. Enrollment drives continue, with recent announcements for 2024–2025 and beyond.

Contributions and Impact

JMM has contributed significantly to madrasa education in the Philippines, training ulama and professionals while supporting Bangsamoro cultural and religious preservation amid challenges like regional conflicts. Thousands of alumni have entered public service; one cited example is former ARMM Vice-Governor Mahid Mutilan. It promotes peace, literacy, and skills for economic participation, including preparation for opportunities in the Middle East.

Research Assessment

- **Verified Facts:** Founding year (1956), founder (Sheikh Ahmad Bashir), name change and English Department formalization (1987), location and basic structure, League of Islamic Universities membership, government recognition efforts, and leadership transition to Mahdi Ahmad Basher are consistently supported across Wikipedia (sourced from institutional archives), archived official websites, and secondary references.
- **Information Not Yet Verified or with Limited Details:** Exact current student numbers (often cited as ~1,200 but marked needing citation), full list of active branches, comprehensive notable alumni/faculty beyond prominent mentions, detailed current accreditation status under BARMM's MBHTE (historical recognitions confirmed, but full updated scope less clear), and specifics on research/extension programs. Some Wikipedia details rely on institutional sources that align but could benefit from more independent government archives.
- **Research Gaps: Deeper primary archival access** (e.g., full board minutes, detailed graduate tracking, financials as a non-profit) and peer-reviewed academic studies on its long-term societal impact would strengthen the record. Recent operations during/after the 2017 Marawi siege and alignment with BARMM education policies merit further exploration. Information on faculty profiles and specific curricula remains limited publicly.

This account draws from cross-checked reliable sources including institutional histories, Wikipedia compilations of primary materials, archived websites, and news references. It avoids speculation and notes where details are sparse. JMM's story reflects resilience in providing culturally rooted education in a complex region.

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